

Statistics related to India

www.indiastat.com

Even if information about India is available at different sources, it is difficult to collate credible information. Welcome to Indiastat.com, a comprehensive resource on India-specific, socio-economic statistics "culled from various secondary level authentic sources." The site is a research aggregator, providing analyses and condensed statistical data from several sites.

Indiastat.com is a paid site, accessible only on to bona fide researchers, academicians, academic institutions, NGOs, libraries, government departments and corporates. Topics include demographics, crime, foreign trade, media, telecommunications, education, geographical data, etc.

The good news is that there are over five lakh pages of statistical data that has been quantitatively analysed, and each can be downloaded in MS Excel or HTML formats. There are weekly updates to most of the figures provided on the site. All the new updates are methodically presented on the home page making it easy for any subscriber to understand.

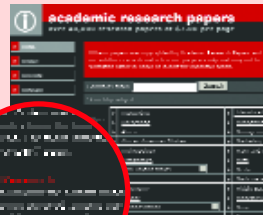
Single user access on Indiastat.com costs Rs 8,000 for researchers and academicians, and Rs 11,000 for other individuals, whereas two-user access for government departments and NGOs would set you back by Rs 15,000. Two-user access for individuals costs Rs 17,500.

IT research papers

www.bitpipe.com

Bitpipe Library, an award winning site, has everything in IT, ranging from white papers, product literature, Web casts and case studies. Its modus operandi is quite simple—it collects research material and distributes it to over 3,500 worldwide vendors and magazines such as Information Week, Network Computing, Forbes, etc.

Academic Research Papers lets you order term papers custom-written by experienced professionals



Bitpipe's 'Hot Topic' section features exhaustive information—including white papers, product info, and Web casts—on a specific topic



Poynter's Resource Centre provides links to archived news stories, tip sheets, and other media-related information



Business Intelligence provides access to research papers on a wide variety of business-related topics



More often than not, free research does not carry valuable up-to-date statistics or specific insights I am seeking

Mohan Krishnan,
Content Specialist

Engineering and Commerce

www.ntis.gov/

The National Technical Information Service (NTIS), a site maintained by the US Department of Commerce, is a resource for scientific, technical, engineering, and business related information. The site provides information on more than six lakh information products covering over 350 subject areas from over 200 federal agencies.

The products are available in a variety of formats—online, multimedia, CD-ROM, paper, and microfiche. Archival records can be accessed for a nominal fee. NTIS offers information on computer products, databases, multimedia, IT-based publications and reports and related information.

Media and related issues

www.poynter.org and www.media-management.org/

For most practising media professionals, Poynter is nothing short of being the Bible. It has some of the best resources you could ever ask for—columnists, white papers, skills upgradation workshops, analytical essays, and contributions

from the best journalists and editors from across the world. It has extensive writing on publishing design as well as media on the Internet. For the most part, it is free, funded by the US-based Poynter Institute.

Net Academy, on the other hand, is one of the first sites set up to collate research on media management, a concept so new that there is no established common body of knowledge. At the fundamental level, Net Academy is a network of research communities, each of which "accumulates, disseminates and reviews academic content and activities according to its own organisational principles and quality standards."

Net Academy was established by the University of St Gallen in Switzerland to promote research in media management, and will take some time to achieve a high degree of depth, but it is a beginning that took a long time coming.

Business Management

www.businessintelligence.com

Business Intelligence is a comprehensive management resource site with extensive research on business performance management, reporting, analysis, customer relationship management and data management. To access its research papers, you need to register (it's free), after which you are sent the requested paper via e-mail. With detailed sections on news, research, various business articles from the best magazines, Business Intelligence is a complete business management site. ■

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Five Reasons Why Google Doesn't Always Work

Google is not a meta search engine

A meta search, simply put, is a search of searches from various resources on the Web. There are meta meta searches which search meta search engines as well for greater detail.

Google takes only 10 words in its search field

Meta search engines have the ability to search entire paragraphs, leading to greater accuracy.

Google searches based on PageRank

Google's searches are based on how many sites have linked to a particular page. This means that new, yet relevant Web sites will get left out of the initial search results.

Google throws up linear search results

Google, for all its intelligence, does not categorise search results, making it a uni-dimensional search site. Try vivisimo.com, and see how the results are multi-layered giving it all the depth a research site needs.

Google does not have domain expertise

This means that if you are researching Apple (as in the computer company) or Cricket (as in the game), it is likely that the results you get will include the fruit or the insect. Get the picture? Research sites, on the other hand, are domain specific, and can throw up results most specific.